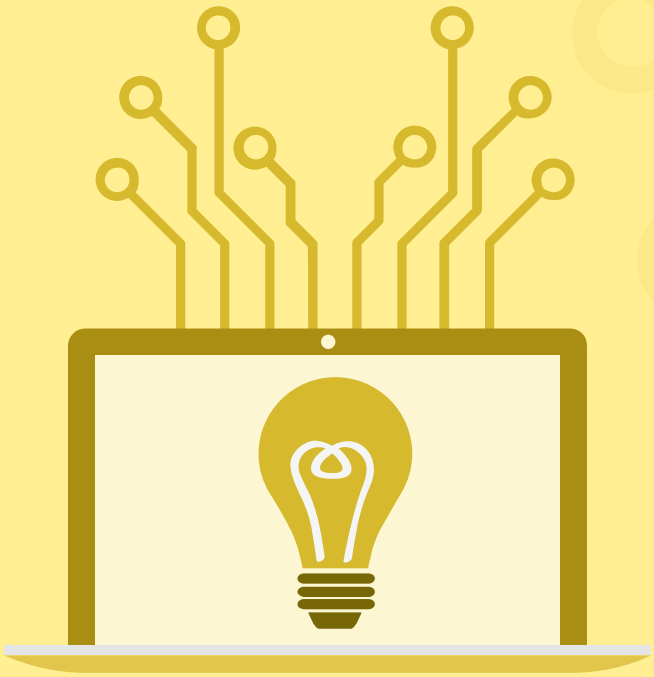
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A COMPLETE GUIDE TO ITIL® CERTIFICATION

A STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

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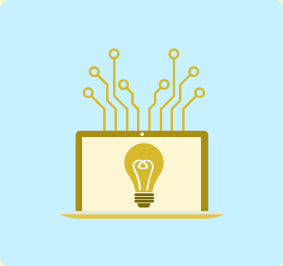
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About ITIL® & Its History



Information Technology Infrastructure Library or ITIL® is a set of best practices for IT Service Management (ITSM) that helps individuals and organizations use IT to realize business change, transformation and maximize growth. ITIL® advocates that IT services should be aligned to support the needs of business and its core processes. ITIL® is based on a set of publications that encompass the entire ITIL® Service Lifecycle which covers customer needs, design & implementation of IT Service, monitoring and improving.

Essentially, ITIL® is a set of 5 books that deal with the core aspects of IT Service Management. These are:

• Service Strategy

Details how to identify market opportunities for new services, enabling you to design, develop and implement service provider strategy aligned to your organizational strategy.

• Service Design

This book focuses on design of IT services and covers the architecture, processes, policies and documentation that is essential to design services that meet the requirements of your organization or programme.

• Service Transition

This book focuses on the process and practice elements along with management techniques required to build, test and implement products/services.

• Service Operation

Focuses on the principles, processes, operational activities and functions that enable organizations or individuals to successfully manage how their products and services perform which indirectly contributes to the improvement of IT Service Management.

• Continual Service Improvement

Continual Service Improvement is accountable for managing improvement to IT Service Management Processes and IT Services.

These five books go into great depths of detail into various aspects of ITIL®. In order to clear your ITIL® Foundation exam, it is not required that you read all five books but rather have a general understanding of these books. This can be done by going through the **ITIL® Foundation training** study material provided by an Accredited Training Institute such as Simplilearn.

ITIL® is supported by a wide range of publications, consultancy, and software tools and is highly adaptable to varying business needs. For individuals, ITIL® offers a range of courses/certifications that can be taken up from anywhere in the world.

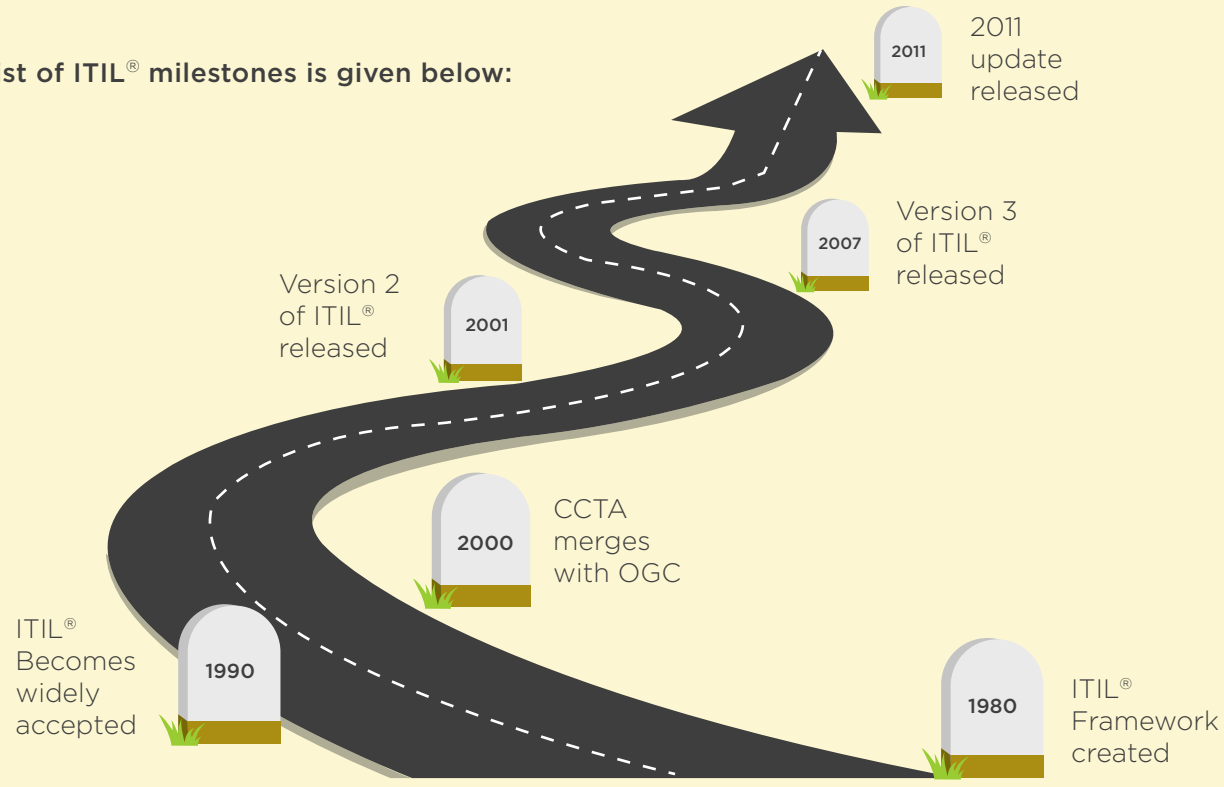
History of ITIL®

History of ITIL® dates back to late 1970's/ early 80's when UK Government realized the level of IT service quality delivered to them was below par. The Central Computer and Telecommunications Agency (CCTA), now the Office of Government Commerce (OGC) was assigned the task of developing an efficient framework for the use of IT resources within the Government and even in the private sector.

Earlier, ITIL® was called GITIM (Government Information Technology Infrastructure Management) which was very different from the present version but it was also designed around IT service support and delivery. Because of the efficiency of the framework, large companies adopted ITIL® very quickly and the popularity of ITIL® grew. In the year 2000, Microsoft used ITIL® as a foundation to develop their own proprietary Microsoft Operations Framework (MOF) which greatly enhanced the reputation and acceptance of ITIL® among other companies.

The latest version of ITIL® is ITIL 2011 which was released in July 2011. It is an update to ITIL V3. ITIL® is presently owned by Axelos, new joint venture formed between the UK Cabinet Office and Capita Plc.

A brief list of ITIL® milestones is given below:



Why should you take up ITIL® certification?



For over 35 years, ITIL® has been considered the Gold standard for organizations and individuals who are in customer-focused, service management. IT has integrated itself as an indispensable part of any modern-day organization/industry so (with ITIL® being considered the standard) understating key concepts of ITIL® is becoming not just expected, but rather essential.

Key Benefits of ITIL®:

Adopting and applying ITIL® enables service providers to:

- Enable business change
- Support business outcomes
- Continually improve
- Optimize customer experience
- Demonstrate value for money
- Manage risk

As a professional who is certified in ITIL®, you can deliver these benefits to your employer and additionally you'll be able to fully understand IT Service Management Lifecycle enabling faster career progression and better pay. This is mainly because you can:

- Learn about ITIL® Tools, how to apply them and improve your efficiency and effectiveness.
- Identify and emphasize on highest value activities that provide value to your organization.
- Use common terminology which allows you to communicate and interact better with global teams.
- Create plans based on best practices which significantly improve chances of successful change.

Also, ITIL® delivers real business benefits by enabling business change, optimizing customer experience and managing risks which means companies would always prefer hiring professionals with an understanding of ITIL® over someone who doesn't. The fact that most of the concepts in ITIL® are already in use/implemented (at least in parts) and they are simple to understand makes this certification attractive to professionals from diverse backgrounds.

As more and more companies including corporations and public sector businesses move onto Cloud, Agile and BYOD (Bring Your Own Device), ITIL® is becoming more relevant today than ever in its 25-year history.

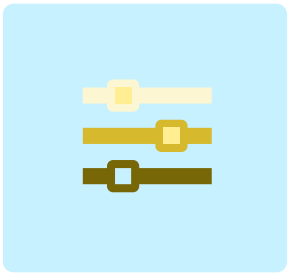
Here is a small list of organizations* that have adopted and benefitted out of ITIL®:



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For professionals who are looking to join any of these or any similar organization, an **ITIL® certification** would definitely be an added advantage.

Levels of ITIL® Certification

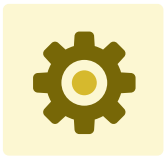


The ITIL® certification scheme offers a modular approach, which consists of a series of qualifications focused on different aspects of ITIL® best practices. Each module has different degrees of detail which offers ITIL® aspirants flexibility in terms of choosing the right area of focus and certification.

Four levels of ITIL® certification are:



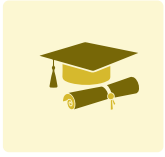
Foundation Level



Intermediate Level



Expert Level



Master Level

We'll now go briefly into these levels for better understanding.

Foundation Level



Like the name suggests, this is the entry level qualification into the world of ITIL®. The Foundation level offers great insight into key elements, concepts and terminology used in ITIL® service lifecycle. The Foundation level will take you through various lifecycle stages, different processes and how they apply to service management practices.

NOTE: ***ITIL® Foundation*** *level is mandatory for all other certifications in the ITIL® scheme.*

Preparing for your ITIL® Foundation Certification

ITIL® Foundation is a very simple, straight-forward multiple choice certification examination that is relatively easy to clear-with the right preparation and guidance. ITIL® Foundation level exam tests you understanding of key concepts of ITIL® with not much importance on applicability of these concepts.

ITIL® Foundation level permits self-study for preparation, however it is advisable to undergo **ITIL® training** from an Accredited Training Organization such as Simplilearn as it would significantly reduce the time required for preparation and you will have access to quality trainers and condensed version of the Five Books that you'll otherwise have to read before taking up the exam.

With the coming of online mode of ITIL® training, the cost of getting trained has significantly reduced and another added advantage is that you'll have assistance when booking your exam.

If preparing with the help of an Accredited Training Organization such as Simplilearn and you are putting in a certain number of hours for study every day, you will be ready for the exam in as little as **10 days.** Within this time you can go through the material, take mock exams, revise and be certified.

Choosing your Accredited Training Organization/Provider



Accreditation

Ensure your training provider is accredited by AXELOS. Simplilearn is a globally recognized Certified Training Partner with AXELOS for all Level of ITIL® Certification.



eLearning

eLearning offers you the freedom to prepare as per your convenience. We always advise you to opt for blended model preparation-a mix of online and classroom; however eLearning is now the preferred mode of preparation for working professionals. To view our offerings under the ITIL® Foundation course from Simplilearn offers, please visit our **website.**



Experience and Support

Ensure your training provider has a history of providing training across all modules of ITIL® and offers support. It is only natural that you'll have lots of queries during the course of your preparation so your training provider should offer support throughout.

For Foundation level, we recommend you enroll for an **Online ITIL® Foundation training** as this mode of perperation would be more than enough to clear the exam.

Online training will be economical and convenient but when choosing this mode of training, it is recommended that you go for an Accredited ATO. Training organizations that meet AXELOS standards are given the ATO or Accredited Training Organization accreditation which implies you can register for training with these organizations for your certification.

Most accredited ATOs including Simplilearn will provide you with condensed study materials prepared by expert trainers based on past experience, in online format and most importantly, you'll get a sense of continuity when going ahead with the Intermediate and higher level certifications.

Who should take up ITIL® Foundation?

The ITIL® Foundation level certification is ideal for professionals who need:

- Basic understanding of ITIL®
- To understand how ITIL® can be used to enhance IT Service Management within their organization
- IT Professionals who are working in or seeking to join organizations that have adopted ITIL®

However, since almost all organizations today are IT-dependent, ITIL® has become one of the most sought-after certifications on any IT professional's resume.

ITIL® Foundation Exam Format

- 40 Multiple-choice questions
- 60 minutes of duration
- 26 correct answers required for passing (65%)
- No negative marking
- Closed book exam

Preparing for your ITIL® Foundation Exam:

Even though ITIL® Foundation is a relatively simple examination, you should not underestimate the difficulty of questions. Multiple choice questions are known to cause confusion and unless you are really clear with concepts, you might have difficulty finding the right answers especially if you are new to IT Service Management. The best way to prepare is to completely go through the study-material provided by your ATO or the study material you have purchased.

A very important point to mention here is that because of the popularity of ITIL® certification, there are lots of illegitimate or "grey" ITIL® preparation materials available for download/purchase. It is recommended that you use the material provided by your ATO or purchase material from AXELOS recommended sources which will ensure you are preparing to the right syllabus and more importantly, your knowledge and skillset are accurate and current.

Tips to Pass ITIL® Foundation Exam

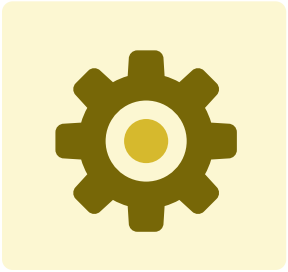
- Thoroughly read the material given by your Training Organization.
- Practice mock tests. The more, the better.
- Read glossary section often.

Additional tips

- Time yourself during mock tests and evaluate each incorrect answer.
- Practice eliminating incorrect answers and zeroing in on most correct answer. This technique will help you save time during the exam.
- Read about more quick tips to pass your ITIL® Foundation Exam **here**

You can expect the results of your Foundation Exam immediately after completion for but for Intermediate level, answers are evaluated at the Examination Institute (APMG in case of Simplilearn) and the results will be available within 7-10 days. The ATO you have enrolled with will give you the results as and when they are available.

Intermediate Level



Following ITIL® Foundation is the Intermediate level which focuses on different modules of IT Service Management. The Intermediate level goes into detail the concepts you learned during the Foundation level and you are free to choose as few or as many modules you want. Modules in ITIL® are divided into two categories: Service Lifecycle and Service Capability.

Who should take up ITIL® Intermediate?

Depending upon their area of interest or expertise, candidates can choose either of these modules but to have a comprehensive understanding of management and technical aspects contained in ITIL®, it is recommended that you pick both as per relevance to your career. Because ITIL® Intermediate is more in-depth, the course is ideal for professionals having two or more years of experience working in an IT Service Management-related environment.

Although you can undergo self-study for ITIL® Foundation level, it is MANDATORY to undergo training from an authorized Accredited Training Organization such as Simplilearn for your Intermediate Certification.

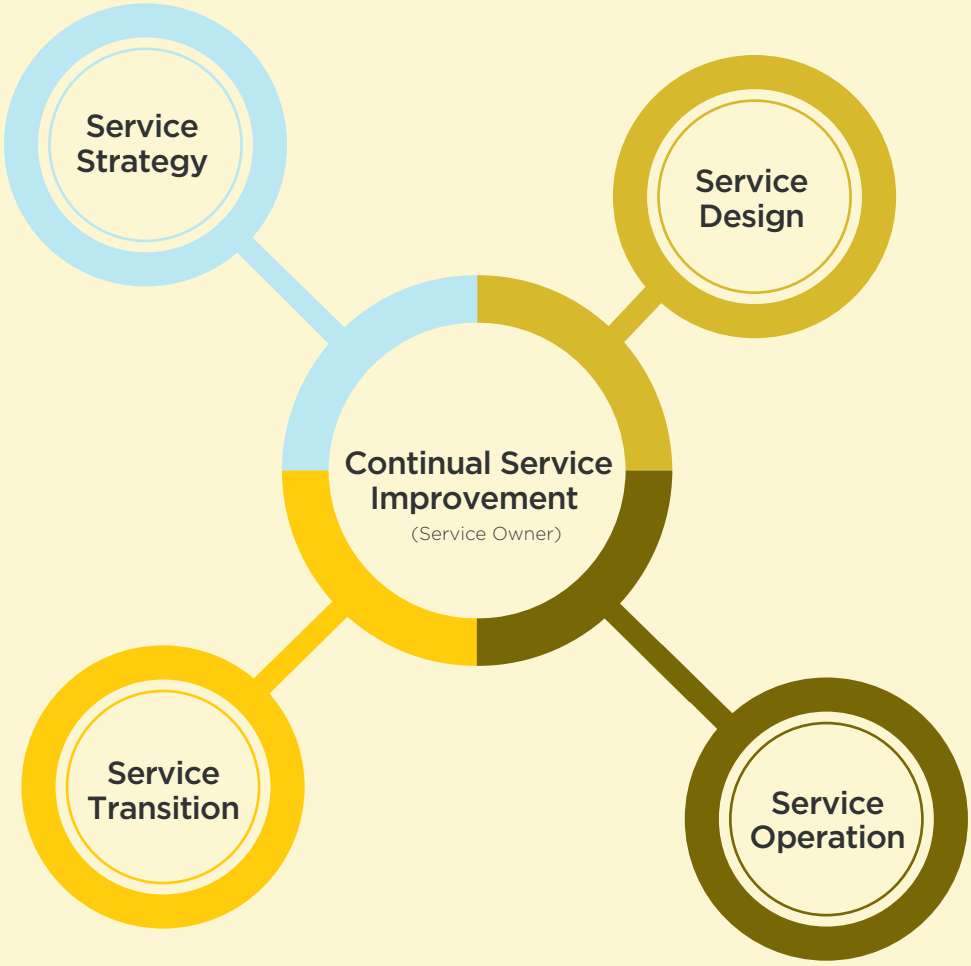
Let's look at the two categories in ITIL® Intermediate Certification.

Service Lifecycle

These modules are particularly useful for professionals who have experience or are looking to get into a team-lead or a management role. The modules in Service Lifecycle are focused on process, practice elements used and management capabilities required to deliver high quality Service Management practices.

Service Lifecycle Modules are:

- **Service Strategy (SS)**
- **Service Design (SD)**
- **Service Transition (ST)**
- **Service Operation (SO)**
- **Continual Service Improvement (CSI)**



Service Capability

These modules are generally for professionals who want to gain specialized knowledge in one or more processes that focus on everyday execution of ITIL® practices and how these processes and practices relate to each other. As you probably guessed, these modules are for professionals who are very specific in their area of interest and long-term careers goals.

Service Lifecycle Modules are:

- **Operational Support and Analysis (OSA)**
- **Planning, Protection and Optimization (PPO)**
- **Release, Control and Validation (RCV)**
- **Service Offerings and Agreements (SOA)**

Preparing for your ITIL® Intermediate Exam

Since the ITIL® Intermediate course is fairly in-depth, you will have to spend more time for preperation than the Foundation level. Time required for preparation varies with individuals' experience, knowledge and other factors. On an average, you should time your preparation such that you are able to go through the course materials (videos/e-books) provided by your training provider comfortably and revise before taking up the exam.

For instance, Simplilearn offers eLearning for **ITIL® Intermediate** modules with 10 hours of audio-video chapters. From this, you can estimate how much time it would take for you to prepare for the exam including time to go through eBooks, mock tests and revision.

ITIL® Intermediate Exam format:

- Exam duration is 90 minutes and exam is closed book.
- Multiple choice, scenario-based, gradient scored questions.
- 8 questions per paper with 5 marks per each question, making 40 marks available in total.

Scoring Model

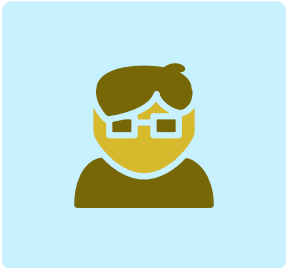
- 5 marks for the most correct answer
- 3 marks for the partially correct answer
- 1 for the least correct answer
- 0 marks for the distractor

Pass percentage(%) is 70 or you need to score 28 marks out of total available.

Additional Preparation Tips:

Intermediate Exam will test the applicability of your knowledge so it is important that you prepare with scenario-based mock exams. It is also essential that you time yourself during the exam so that you will be able to complete the exam and check all answers before time runs out.

Expert Level



ITIL® Expert Level of Certification is aimed at professionals who want to demonstrate their knowledge and expertise in the ITIL® scheme in its entirety. The Expert level certification is only given to those professionals who have cleared a range of different ITIL® exams and have demonstrable expertise/superior knowledge in ITIL® Best Practices.

Visit Simplilearn's **ITIL® Expert training** page to know more.

ITIL® Expert level professionals are highly valued and much sought-after because this certification clearly demonstrates a higher capability and skill-level in the IT Service Management domain. This certification will help professionals in developing their careers and their skillset in a unique way that attracts potential employers depending on individuals' industry-experience.

ITIL® Expert level certification is also mandatory if you want to go ahead with your ITIL® Master certification which is the ultimate certification in the ITIL® scheme.

Who should take up ITIL® Expert?

ITIL® Expert certification is taken up by diverse range of professionals, so the combination of requirements for this level is fairly large. Here are few of them:

- All candidates should have the ITIL® Foundation certificate/a Bridge qualification equivalent.
- Candidates must have earned a minimum total of 17 credits from the Foundation and Intermediate modules.
- Credits from earlier qualifications and complementary qualifications can also be counted for these 17 credits.
- Once you have 17 credits, you should take the Managing Across the Lifecycle (MALC) module which if passed takes your overall credit to 22-the minimum required for ITIL® Expert Level.

Note: It is MANDATORY to undergo training from an authorized Accredited Training Organization such as Simplilearn for your ITIL® Expert Certification.

The credit system is in place so that all candidates who clear the Expert level will have a well-rounded knowledge on the complete ITIL® Service Lifecycle. To know more about ITIL® credit system click **here**

ITIL® Expert certification is ideal for candidates such as Senior IT Managers, IT Managers, Supervisors, IT professionals, IT Operations/Development Practitioners, CIOs and any individual who needs to know the ITIL® Service Lifecycle or who wants to implement ITIL® in their business or work environment/attain the Master level certification.

Different Examination Institutes (these are organization accredited and approved by AXLEOS to conduct ITIL® examinations, ex: APMG International, EXIN, PEOPLECERT and so on to which Simplilearn is accredited to) have different processes in place for awarding the Expert level of certification, however, the institute that provides you with the MALC certificate will usually certify you in the Expert level.

In the past there were also certifications known as Service Manager or Practitioner qualifications which can still be used toward your ITIL® Expert certification.

About the MALC Exam:

The MALC module is sort of an intermediary between Intermediate and Expert level certification. This module is designed to help candidates apply the theoretical knowledge they have acquired with ITIL® training within a real-world environment or their real workplace.

MALC (Managing Across the Lifecycle) Exam Format:

- Multiple choice examination questions
- 10 questions per paper
- 35 marks required to pass (out of 50 available) - 70%
- 120 minutes' duration
- Closed book

Tips for your ITIL® Expert Certification:

When choosing modules for ITIL® expert certification, ensure that you have clear picture of why you are taking up each module. The Expert level certification is aimed at professionals who are specific in their roles and want to gain expertise in their domains. ITIL® Expert certification exam will test your theoretical and practical knowledge of ITIL® so it is important that you apply principles of ITIL® learned before you appear for the exam.

Simplilearn has trained candidates on ITIL® Expert level certification and our experience successfully training candidates can greatly benefit your preparation. Here are few additional pointers to help with your ITIL® Expert Certification:

- Before starting with your ITIL® Expert training, go through the course material (online or offline) provided by your ATO such as Simplilearn so that you understand concepts really well as and when the training begins.

- Having support or an instructor is really important when preparing for the Expert level so ensure your ATO provides you this option even if the course is online.

- Do as many mock tests as possible. Simplilearn offers **10 mock tests** for ITIL® Expert level which is enough to get you a real feel of the exam and help you be thoroughly prepared.

- During the mock exam identify your weak areas by evaluating each right and wrong answer. Later go through your weak areas so that you have absolute clarity, which will reduce chances of making the same mistake in the real exam.

- Also when taking the mock test, time yourself so that you will be able to complete the real exam with time to spare for checking all answers before final submission.

Additional tips:

Go through Opportunities/Threats sections and always think in terms of "Why this is important to ITIL®/ Why this is important to business?"

When answering, remember that the best answer usually related to business strategy rather than just IT. There will be questions to cause confusion among these two.

The correct answer will usually involve some sort of communication or interaction with others.

Beware of questions containing “All”/”None” in answers. Our experience tells that candidates make most mistakes with questions involving these.

Ensure the right answer you pick relates to the right stage in lifecycle to which the question is directed.

Your chances of clearing the exam will significantly increase depending on your capability to identify distractors. Eliminate two wrong answers and then think carefully before choosing your answer.

ITIL® Master Level Certification



As you would know, ITIL® has a wide range of IT Service related knowledge, principles, methods, techniques and management techniques that are used to achieve desired business outcomes. In order for you to attain your ITIL® Master Certification, you should be able to explain clearly how you have personally selected and applied this knowledge in the real-world.

Each ITIL® Master candidate will select a unique, personal range of experiences and hence there is no fixed syllabus for this certification. Also note that there is no prescribed training course for this level of certification since you have already learnt the theoretical aspect of ITIL® in previous levels and the Master level is all about how you apply this knowledge depending upon the situation each candidate chooses.

Eligibility for ITIL® Master Qualification

- Should have reached ITIL® Expert level.
- Should have worked in an IT Service Management environment for a minimum of five years in leadership, managerial or high management/advisory levels.
- To successfully certify yourself as an ITIL® Master, you will need sufficient, demonstrable practical or hands-on experience in the implementation of ITIL® practices.
- ITIL® Master level certification also needs a number of documents to prove and support your eligibility.

As per the official AXELOS website, information on ITIL Master qualification will be made to the public shortly. If you like to know more about ITIL® Master level certification, please write to any Examination Institute such as Simplilearn.

Additional Resources that could be useful:

- **Common ITIL® mistakes**
- **ITIL core concepts and advantages**

Conclusion

ITIL® is a set of advice/guidelines that has evolved over the last 25 years offering the best possible techniques to deliver IT Services. There are no hard and bound rules within ITIL® and you can always choose what to implement when it comes to applying your knowledge. As the world of IT Service Management evolves with the coming of new technology and processes, we can expect ITIL® to evolve but key concepts will always remain the same. Being ITIL® certified will greatly enhance your understanding of the functioning of any IT company which gives you a professional advantage over similar, non-certified aspirants.

Benefits of ITIL® Certification from Simplilearn

- Experience of having trained over 200,000 professionals across Courses
- Training available for Foundation, Intermediate and Expert levels in Online
- Classroom and Instructor-led Classroom formats
- Condensed Study materials
- Experienced Trainers for clarifying doubts
- PMP® PDUs with ITIL® Training
- Multiple Simulation Exams
- Industry-based Case Studies

Other Courses that complement your ITIL® Certification

There are plenty of certifications that greatly complement your ITIL® certification. Some of them are:



PMP®:

Project Management Professional (PMP)® Certification is the most coveted credential in project management offered by the reputed PMI. Simplilearn offers both online PMP® training and PMP® classroom training coupled with PMP® live webinars, sample PMP® exam questions and mock PMP® practice exams.



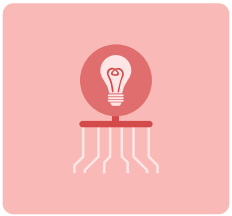
PRINCE2®:

PRINCE2 (PRojects IN Controlled Environments) is a product-based project management methodology. The standard is recognized widely in the private sector, in UK and internationally.



Six Sigma

Six Sigma is a rigorous and systematic method of identifying defects and eliminating them in manufacturing and service-related processes.
To know more about various levels in Six Sigma and our offerings, visit our course page



TOGAF®

TOGAF® which stands for The Open Group Architecture Framework, is a frame work entailing a detailed method and a set of supporting tools used in developing enterprise architecture. It equips the enterprise architects and trainers with core knowledge and practical skills about Enterprise Architecture. Know More!

ITIL® training from Simplilearn gives you the right guidance and flexibility to prepare as per your convenience.



Classroom Sessions



24 Hrs e-Learning content



90 Days e-Learning Access



30 PDUs Offered



ITIL® participant hand book



Courseware Approved by AXELOS



8 downloadable e-books



Doubt clearing sessions

Good Luck!

For more information on our ITIL® offerings, please visit our course page **here**